

Ben Chidgey

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Location: Saint Albans, Hertfordshire

Passionate multi-disciplined Senior Full Stack Software Engineer with web development, web design, architecture, infrastructure, dev-ops and quality assurance experience. Expertise in client-side development with the core fundamentals of JavaScript, React.js, HTML and CSS. Server-side expertise with Node.js, Next.js, Lambda, REST and GraphQL. Extensive knowledge of multiple frameworks, patterns, methodologies and approaches used to successfully build and maintain utilities, products and software for business.

Practical and analytical thinker, capable of de-constructing complex problems into easy to manage modular parts. Strong communicator, constructive and collaborative team member, confident with the translation of product, business and user requirements into robust digital solutions.

Experienced with working on large scale dynamic web applications in a team and as a sole engineer. Confident and proactive with managing workload and adaptive to changes and new approaches to web development, design and understanding user, business and developer needs. Keen on documented, well written, progressively-enhanced, functional code with strong test coverage. Alongside great design and memorable user experience.

Being an integral part of a cross-functional team building resilient products with well considered user experiences is something I enjoy and do very well. I'm a huge fan of small, efficient, disciplined teams that have the autonomy, passion and the skillset to build great products. Products that allow businesses and users to perform complex functions with ease.

Expertise

JavaScript, Node.js, CSS, Html, React.js, Next.js, Jest, Express, AWS, GCP, Cypress, Git, UI, User Experience, Agile, Scrum, Kanban, Architecture, CI, CD, Dev Ops, Infrastructure, Web development, Web design, User Research, Google Cloud Platform, REST, GraphQL, TypeScript, Storybook, Documentation, Mentoring, Pair programming.

Experience

WhiskyInvestDirect - Full Stack Engineer

Apr 2026 – Present. Remote, London. Contract

Consultant Full Stack Engineer leading a greenfield rebuild of WhiskyInvestDirect's core platform. Modernising architecture and processes whilst establishing best practices and embedding quality across engineering, delivery and product.

Expertise: UX, UI, Design, Accessibility, Progressive enhancement, Web Application, Mobile

Application, SvelteKit, fastify, TypeScript, Database, AWS, Vitest, Playwright, Testing Strategy, CI/CD, Monitoring, Observability, Best Practices.

Department for Environment, Food and Rural Affairs - Full Stack JavaScript Platform Engineer

Mar 2023 – Feb 2026. Remote, Contract.

Full Stack JavaScript Platform Engineer, helping out the Platform team at DEFRA to build the Core Delivery Platform - Portal.

Expertise: Node.js, Hapi.js, GOV Frontend, JavaScript, AWS, CSS, Html, Design, UX, UI, AWS, GitHub Actions.

Wayfair - Software Engineer

Aug 2022 – Dec 2022. Remote, Contract.

Software Engineer on the Global Transportation Services (GTS) team. Creating the Freight Portal Frontend UI micro-service. The Freight Portal is the place users find information and interact with all Wayfair facility services.

Expertise: React.js, TypeScript, Jest, Cypress, JavaScript, CSS, Html, Accessibility, DataDog, Kubernetes, BuildKite CI, User Experience, Design.

Wayfair - Senior Frontend Engineer / Tech Lead

Jan 2022 – Aug 2022. Remote, Contract.

Senior Frontend Engineer / Tech Lead on the Global Customs Platform team. Creating the Customs Portal Frontend UI micro-service.

Expertise: React.js, TypeScript, Jest, Cypress, JavaScript, CSS, Html, Accessibility, UX, DataDog, Kubernetes, BuildKite CI, User Experience, Design.

Pret A Manger - Platform Engineer

Jan 2021 – Dec 2021. Remote, Contract.

Engineer on the Platform Team at Pret A Manger.

- Creation of custom metrics Backstage plugin, TypeScript Google function and Express API backed by Postgres Database to provide Platform wide SRE/Accelerate metrics
- Sentry Observability Terraform setup and roll out to the Platform
- Next.js and Express API template repositories for the Platform
- Running Chaos experiment sessions and set up of Incident exercise applications and

- sessions for teams on the Platform
- GCP Admin, metrics and Terraform

Expertise: Node.js, React.js, Next.js, TypeScript, Lambda/Functions, Google Cloud Platform, BackStage, Terraform, GitHub Actions, Jest, Cypress, JavaScript, CSS, Html, Accessibility, Chaos experiments, Incident exercises.

LifeBoxHealth - Senior Full Stack Developer

Jul 2020 – Dec 2020. Brighton / Remote, Contract.

Helping out the team at LifeBox Health scale their application for new business.

Expertise: React.js, GraphQL, Node.js, AWS, Lambda, JavaScript, CSS, Html, Accessibility, Jest, CodeceptJs, UX, UI, Design, Mentoring.

Rewind - Senior Frontend Developer

Feb 2020 – March 2020. St Albans, Contract.

Senior Frontend Developer helping out the team at Rewind with a Leaflet map for the Dubai 2020 mobile app.

Expertise: Node.js, JavaScript, CSS, Html, Accessibility, UX, UI, Design, Leaflet maps.

Ministry of Justice UK - Senior Full Stack Developer

Aug 2019 – Dec 2019. London, Contract.

Senior Full Stack Developer working on the Prisoner Escort & Custody Service (PECS).

Expertise: Node.js, JavaScript, CSS, Html, Progressive enhancement, Express, Accessibility, Git, GOV Pattern Library, Kubernetes, Jest, Testcafe.

Marks and Spencer - Senior Full Stack Developer

Apr 2019 – Aug 2019. London, Contract.

Senior Full Stack Developer working on the framework team providing tools for the dot com online business.

Expertise: Node.js, JavaScript, CSS, Html, Progressive enhancement, React, Jest, Express, Accessibility, Git, Linux, Mentoring, Architecture, Concourse, Pattern Library, Framework.

HM Passport Office - Senior Full Stack Developer

Oct 2018 – Dec 2018. London, Contract.

Senior Full Stack Developer working with the established Strategic Appointment Booking team.

Tasked with understanding an existing legacy booking system and associated public facing journeys. To then re-build and bring in-house.

Working with the development and design team we created and proposed a new road map whilst managing expectations with senior stakeholders. The development team then continued on to create a Node.js microservice application and journeys.

Expertise: Node.js, JavaScript, CSS, Html, Progressive enhancement, Home Office Forms, express, Jest, Continuous Integration, Micro service, Redis, GOV.UK Pay, Accessibility, Git, Linux.

Department for International Trade - Senior Full Stack Developer

May 2017 – Mar 2018. London, Contract.

Senior Full Stack Developer working with the Data Hub team. Providing software and infrastructure to enable civil servants to manage business relationships for UK trade and investment.

Expertise: Node.js, JavaScript, CSS, Html, React, Vue.js, Progressive enhancement, Accessibility, Pattern library, Git, Linux, Nunjucks, express, Docker, Redis, CircleCi, GreenKeeper, nightwatch, SSO, mentoring, Architecture, Continuous Integration, Continuous Delivery.

HM Revenue & Customs - Senior Frontend Developer

Sep 2016 – Apr 2017. London, Contract.

Service Design Tools

Working in a small team tasked with creating the HMRC design language and related documentation, process, principles and tools. The design language enables designers and developers to efficiently build frontend services for the Tax Platform, whilst providing parity across HMRC's digital offerings.

We are also liaising closely with GDS (Government Digital Service) and participating in a GOV wide design language community.

Expertise: Frontend Operations, Frontend Architecture, AWS, Pattern library, Node.js, JavaScript, Html, CSS(Sass), Scala, Responsive Design, Accessibility, Technical and Design Documentation, Process, Community building, Mentoring.

HM Revenue & Customs - Senior Frontend Developer

Feb 2016 – Sep 2017. London, Contract.

Platform Operations

Working with Platform Operations to tackle front end architectural concerns across the Tax Platform. Refactoring of the way we use shared assets across the Platform. Exposure of components via the creation of a component library. Documentation of process and refactoring/improving ways of approaching common issues. Mentoring front end developers and designers and educating them on how to think/create as a service.

Expertise: JavaScript, Html, CSS(Sass), React, Scala, Node.js, Responsive Design, Accessibility, Mentoring.

HM Revenue & Customs - Frontend Developer

Sep 2015 – Feb 2016. London, Contract.

Working with HMRC to develop, modify and maintain the user interfaces for HMRC's new digital services.

Government Gateway

Working with the Government Gateway team I implemented the 2 factor Authentication frontend and registration for the Tax Platform.

Identity Verification

The work on the Identity Verification team involved the creation of generic form validation for client and server side to be used across the Tax Platform and implemented across IV and 2fa.

HMRC API

The HMRC API team's work involved the API documentation site and systems user interface.

Expertise: JavaScript, Html, CSS(Sass), Scala, Node.js, Responsive Design, Accessibility.

Department for Work and Pensions, Universal Credit - Frontend Developer

Apr 2015 – May 2015. London, Contract.

Analysis of a mature codebase. Presentation of suggested improvements for the front end. Tackling tech debt whilst refactoring and improving where needed. Creating UX rapid prototyping tools and workflows for the UX and design team.

Expertise: JavaScript, Html, CSS(Sass), FlightJs, Responsive Design, Accessibility,

Jasmine, Bower, Grunt, Gitlab, Node.js.

Guardian News & Media - Client Side Engineer

Apr 2014 – Apr 2015. London, Contract.

“You've read the Guardian. Maybe, in recent times, you've listened to, or watched the Guardian. You may of come to our building to learn with the Guardian, in one of our Masterclasses. Now you can join the Guardian.” Alan Rusbridger 13/09/2014

Client side Engineer working with the Guardian Membership team on the beta responsive website and associated tools.

Day to day tasks involve working in a lean agile environment performing Client side/Scala tasks using Git flow. Strong communication with fellow developers, UX, Design, Project managers and Stakeholders, coupled with pair programming, code review and continuous integration made for a great working environment and created a highly productive team.

Expertise: JavaScript, Micro JavaScript libraries (jquery, bonzo, bean, request), Html, CSS(Sass, BEM), Responsive Design, Jasmine, Bower, Grunt, Scala, Node.js, Git, Git flow, Continuous Integration, Agile, Pair programming, Code review, Mentoring.

feedMyPixel Ltd. - Research & Development

Feb 2014 – Mar 2014. St Albans, Hertfordshire.

R & D time between contracts getting to know AngularJs.

Expertise: Angular.js, JavaScript.

Deutsche Telekom UK Limited - Mobile Frontend Developer

Oct 2012 – Dec 2013. Hatfield, Hertfordshire, Contract.

Front-end developer working on multiple responsive projects.

Expertise: OO/MVC JavaScript, Html5, CSS3, Responsive Design, Mobile, Node.js, Jessie.

Txt Promotion

A Node.js prototype application for distributing a webpage created via SMS. This project was the whiteboard for a new Node.js skeleton to be used across the middle-end of the company. It was created using Express3, Handlebars, Node.js, OOCSS and Html5.

I created an MVC set up utilising routes, middleware, controllers, models, DAO and utilities. As the work ramped up on the project I was joined by our senior developer which enabled us to discuss and pair on the prototype and the Node.js skeleton.

Expertise: OO/MVC JavaScript, Html5, CSS3, OOCSS, Responsive Design, Mobile, Node.js, Jessie, Agile, Patterns, Pair programming.

Favoriten

A responsive Dashboard for German clients to use Deutsche Telekom services. The project was mature when I started work on it.

I created a new responsive Carousel for the page and worked with the design team to communicate and add responsive principles across the site.

I worked closely with the design team to implement a move functionality for the modules.

I added Grunt to the build process as well as a huge rework of the CSS used across the site.

I added a custom analytics solution to the site.

This site was built with a Java backend, a vanilla JS front end consisting of Modules and Managers instantiated on the specific pages. We also used the functional library for JavaScript Jessie.

Expertise: OO JavaScript, Html5, CSS3, Responsive Design, Mobile, Jessie, Agile.

Globally distributed header

The header that is injected into many of Deutsche Telekom's pages. This script was created using vanilla JS. We decided that it would be best to have this script as small and as light as possible because we were serving it to the various pages.

A light version of analytics was added to the script. Documentation was written and partners included the script in their pages by adding the script and instantiating the header with the ability to send in an options object.

Expertise: OO JavaScript, CSS3, Agile, Documentation.

Tuneup

A responsive platform for advertising assets to customers. The Tuneup app was written to consume data added to our CMS by partners and display it to customers. The site was originally in one file. I rewrote the application and made it responsive as well as creating an adapter for the data used in the app. This enabled us to move to a new CMS when it was rolled out across the company.

Expertise: MVC/OO JavaScript, CSS3, html5, sAgile, Documentation.

BBC - Software Engineer

Aug 2011 – Aug 2012. London, Contract.

Future Media, Core Services. Working on an internal product, iBroadcast2. A Next Generation media and meta-data publishing platform for iPlayer, scheduling and BBC websites.

Working with JQuery, RequireJs, Php, Php Unit and cucumber we produced work in fortnight long sprints.

Expertise: PHP, Zend Framework, JavaScript, jQuery, LessCSS, TDD, BDD, REST, Xhtml,

Linux, Jira, Agile, pair programming.

eDigitalResearch Limited - Application Support Developer

Apr 2010 – July 2011. Southampton, Permanent.

eDigitalResearch specialises in providing analysis and insight into a customer's behaviour. Helping a product and business grow in the right direction, using the knowledge gained through their tools.

Providing support to the company's applications, websites and various in-house tools.

Working with a large number of high profile clients such as Sky, Orange, BT, Expedia, Virgin, BBC, Ann Summers.

Expertise: PHP, Zend framework, JavaScript, jQuery, Mootools, PostGreSql, CSS, Xhtml, Photoshop, Linux.

Web Developer & Designer

Oct 2007 – Apr 2010. Southampton, Freelance.

An opportunity arose to take time to extend my web development knowledge.

Over this period I worked with many aspects involved with developing and producing a large dynamic website controlled by a custom hand-built content management system. This culminated in the creation, design and production of a dynamic website and content management system for the Publisher & Arts collective Lazy Gramophone.

Expertise : PHP, JavaScript, MYSQL, CSS, Xhtml, Flash, Xml, JSON, Ubuntu, Photoshop, API's, SEO.

Lazy Gramophone - Web Developer & Designer

2004 – 2010

Lazy Gramophone is a content driven, community website for the arts collective and publisher.

The website consists of a custom-built editing facility so artists and senior staff can upload text, images, music and video to their profiles and specific sections of the site.

A user invite and management facility enables Lazy Gramophone staff to invite new Artists to seamlessly join the collective and create a profile to upload their work. A comment, approve and reply system has been created allowing users to leave comments about written Journals, Events or Shop items.

Creating a community for the artists to belong to, and Lazy Gramophone to feel proud of, was a central aspect of the design for the new site. This allowed the application to grow intuitively and flourish as Lazy Gramophone and artists add new content to the website and new artists join the collective.

The website and Content Management System have been built from the ground up using PHP and MYSQL, with a custom-built JavaScript Library.

Expertise: PHP, MYSQL, JavaScript, CSS, Xhtml, Photoshop, UX, SEO.

Site: <http://www.lazygramophone.com>

Design Haus - Frontend Developer

Mar 2010 – March 2010. Southampton, Freelance.

A few weeks of freelancing, helping out Design Haus with an overflow of their Front-end Developer work on an internal system for Diageo.

Expertise: jQuery, Xhtml, CSS, Photoshop, UX.

Trusted Digital - Product Design Manager

Jan 2007 – Oct 2007. Brighton, Permanent.

Product Design Manager for Trusted Digital - Mobile Marketing Specialists.

Trusted Digital specialises in the provision of interactive marketing SMS services for mobile handsets and the mobile web.

Expertise: Xhtml-MP, CSS, Xhtml, Photoshop, SEO.

Hotxt - Quality Assurance Manager

Aug 2006 – Dec 2006. London, Permanent.

Quality Assurance Manager for the “text over IP” start-up Hotxt, headed up by Doug Richards.

The introduction of a QA testing structure of the j2me application, across a multitude of mobile handsets and networks was implemented. Forming the beginnings of an in house Quality Assurance department.

I worked closely with the Product manager, and external developer to improve services within the application.

Expertise: QA.

Developer & Designer

Oct 2005 – Jul 2006. Brighton, Freelance.

Freelancer building web based media, mobile media, J2ME mobile game graphics and 3D modelling work.

Expertise: 3DMax, Design, Flash, Premier, Photoshop.

Babel Media - QA technician

Aug 2002 – Sep 2005. Brighton, Permanent.

The time at Babel Media was spent working on two game titles, Mace Griffin Bounty Hunter on the Playstation 2 and Ace Golf on the GameCube testing the games to the various Microsoft and Sony TRC certifications for the game developers.

The remainder of time was spent starting the mobile j2me game and application QA department. We began with three people and quickly grew to 150+. Working closely together to rapidly alter, improve and document the various in-house testing procedures, adapting to new workloads and new operator testing procedures was key to the scalable growth achieved within the department.

In my time with the mobile department my various roles were involved with proto-type handset firmware debugging, known handset issues, mobile technical expertise, java/symbian game/application testing and extensive knowledge of various OP Co certification standards (Vodafone, T-mobile, O2, Orange).

Expertise: Mobile QA, OP Co certification, Test-track pro, Microsoft certification, Sony TRC Certification, Game QA.

Education & Qualifications

University of Hertfordshire - Software Systems for the Arts & Media

1999 - 2002

2.1 Bachelor of Arts with honours

My degree covered: Computer generated imaging, Digital image and sound processes, Principles and theory of hypermedia design, Computer systems and hardware, Digital time-based and interactive media, Computer programming, Cyber culture, Virtual reality, Critical

and theoretical responses to the broader cultural contexts.

Oxford College of Further Education

1999 - 1999

- City and Guilds Certificate of Information Technology for Visual Basic 1
- City and Guilds Certificate of Information Technology for Computing

Gosford Hill School, Kidlington, Oxford

1988 - 1994

GCSE:

- English literature - A
- English Language - A
- Geography - A
- Science - AA
- Business Studies - B
- Mathematics - B
- History - C
- Craft, Design & Technology - D

Activities & Achievements

I regularly enjoy yoga, swimming, walking, cycling and HIT. I am an avid gardener and have a fantastic garden as well as an extensive collection of indoor plants. I also like to bring the garden into the kitchen and thoroughly enjoy cooking for friends and family. I really enjoy my DIY and can be found fixing up, creating or restoring things around my house and garden.

I enjoy keeping up to date with new technologies and spend time on Research & Development, keeping up to date with the latest trends.

References

Available on Request